

GCE Religious Studies

OCR Advanced Subsidiary GCE in Religious Studies H172

OCR Advanced GCE in Religious Studies H572

version 2 – February 2008
specification

1.1	The Two-Unit AS	7
1.2	The Four-Unit Advanced GCE	7
1.3	Qualification Titles and Levels	7
1.4	Aims	7
1.5	Prior Learning/Attainment	8
2	Summary of Content	9
2.1	AS Units	9
2.2	A2 Units	10
3	Unit Content	13
3.1	G571: AS <i>Philosophy of Religion</i>	13
3.2	G572: AS <i>Religious Ethics</i>	17
3.3	G573: AS <i>Jewish Scriptures</i>	20
3.4	G574: AS <i>New Testament</i>	23
3.5	G575: AS <i>Developments in Christian Theology</i>	25
3.6	G576: AS <i>Buddhism</i>	28
3.7	G577: AS <i>Hinduism</i>	31
3.8	G578: AS <i>Islam</i>	34
3.9	G579: AS <i>Judaism</i>	38
3.10	G581: A2 <i>Philosophy of Religion</i>	41
3.11	G582: A2 <i>Religious Ethics</i>	43
3.12	G583: A2 <i>Jewish Scriptures</i>	46
3.13	G584: A2 <i>New Testament</i>	48
3.14	G585: A2 <i>Developments in Christian Theology</i>	51
3.15	G586: A2 <i>Buddhism</i>	54
3.16	G587: A2 <i>Hinduism</i>	57
3.17	G588: A2 <i>Islam</i>	60
3.18	G589: A2 <i>Judaism</i>	62
4	Schemes of Assessment	64
4.1	AS GCE Scheme of Assessment	64
4.2	Advanced GCE Scheme of Assessment	67
4.3	Unit Order	68
4.4	Unit Options (at AS/A2)	68
4.5	Synoptic Assessment (A Level GCE)	69
4.6	Assessment Availability	71

5.1	Making Unit Entries	73
5.2	Making Qualification Entries	73
5.3	Grading	73
5.4	Result Enquiries and Appeals	74
5.5	Shelf-Life of Units	75
5.6	Unit and Qualification Re-sits	75
5.7	Guided Learning Hours	75
5.8	Code of Practice/Subject Criteria/Common Criteria Requirements	75
5.9	Arrangements for Candidates with Particular Requirements	75
5.10	Prohibited Qualifications and Classification Code	76
5.11	Coursework Administration/Regulations	76

6 Other Specification Issues 77

6.1	Overlap with other Qualifications	77
6.2	Progression from these Qualifications	77
6.3	Key Skills Mapping	78
6.4	Spiritual, Moral, Ethical, Social, Legislative, Economic and Cultural Issues	79
6.5	Sustainable Development, Health and Safety Considerations and European Developments	79
6.6	Avoidance of Bias	79
6.7	Language	79
6.8	Disability Discrimination Act Information Relating to these Specifications	80

Appendix A: Performance Descriptions 81

Vertical black lines indicate a significant change to the previous printed version. Changes can be found on pages 13, 44 and 65.

This booklet contains OCR's Advanced Subsidiary GCE and Advanced GCE specifications in Religious Studies for teaching from September 2008.

This specification builds on the knowledge, understanding and skills that candidates may have developed through the study of GCSE Religious Studies. It does not, however, assume or require any previous study of the subject. It is designed to support a course of study which is suitable for candidates from any religious background (or none).

At AS candidates select **two** complementary areas of study from the wide range permitted in the specification. At A2 it is recommended that candidates continue to follow the same subject areas selected at AS. Candidates are free however to select different units at A2 than those studied at AS. In such cases it should be noted that candidates should familiarise themselves with the contents of the corresponding AS, as they may be disadvantaged by not studying the areas covered at AS. The specification, however, is designed to be flexible and does permit combinations of up to four different subject areas for the Advanced GCE qualification. As required by the Subject Criteria, the Advanced GCE specification includes synoptic assessment, in which candidates are asked to show their understanding of the connections between their chosen areas of study and other specified aspects of human experience. This is incorporated fully into the content of all A2 units.

The specification incorporates:

- continuity of content in the areas of the Philosophy of Religion, Religious Ethics, World Religions and Textual papers;
- flexibility in allowing combinations of up to four areas of study in the subject;
- maintenance of established methods of assessment: the need for candidates to answer questions at the full Advanced level with essays which they must plan and structure for themselves;
- the practice of positive awarding, by which examiners are not restricted by a prescriptive marking scheme but are able to reward candidates for any valid response to a reasonable interpretation of the question according to its quality as measured against standard band descriptions.

The specification is linked closely with the OCR GCSE Religious Studies specifications, in both content and in progression of demand.

In AS units, candidates are asked two-part structured questions which relate directly to single areas within the associated module. The questions help candidates to structure their answers to meet the Assessment Objectives.

In A2 units, candidates are expected to display knowledge, understanding and evaluative skills in respect to the specified topics. They are asked essay-style questions in which they may be expected to use material from more than one area within the unit, to draw comparisons and to assess the relative significance of different aspects of the unit. The questions direct candidates towards the Assessment Objectives, but candidates are expected to select their own material and structure it themselves into a coherent answer.

The AS GCE and Advanced GCE specifications require candidates to:

Study one or more of the following areas within Religious Studies:

- philosophy of religion;
- religious ethics;
- textual studies;
- theological studies;
- history of religious tradition(s).

Candidates should acquire knowledge and understanding of:

- the key concepts within the chosen area(s) of study (eg religious beliefs, teachings, doctrines, principles, ideas and theories) and how these are expressed in texts, writings and/or practices;
- the contribution of significant people, traditions or movements to the area(s) studied;
- religious language and terminology;
- major issues and questions arising from the chosen area(s) of study;
- the relationship between the chosen area(s) of study and other specified aspects of human experience.

Candidates should develop the following skills:

- recall, select and deploy specified knowledge;
- identify, investigate and analyse questions and issues arising from the course of study;
- use appropriate language and terminology in context;
- interpret and evaluate religious concepts, issues and ideas, the relevance of arguments and the views of scholars;
- communicate, using reasoned arguments substantiated by evidence;
- develop the skill of making connections between the area(s) of study chosen and other specified aspects of human experience.

In addition, the Advanced GCE specification requires candidates to:

1.1 The Two-Unit AS

The Advanced Subsidiary GCE is both a 'stand-alone' qualification and also the first half of the corresponding Advanced GCE. The AS GCE is assessed at a standard appropriate for candidates who have completed the first year of study (both in terms of teaching time and content) of the corresponding two-year Advanced GCE course, ie between GCSE and Advanced GCE.

From September 2008 the AS GCE is made up of **two** mandatory units chosen from **nine** options, which are externally assessed and form 50% of the corresponding four-unit Advanced GCE.

1.2 The Four-Unit Advanced GCE

From September 2008 the Advanced GCE is made up of **two** mandatory units at AS and **two** further units at A2, again chosen from nine options. These A2 units are also externally assessed.

1.3 Qualification Titles and Levels

These qualifications are shown on a certificate as:

- OCR Advanced Subsidiary GCE in Religious Studies.
- OCR Advanced GCE in Religious Studies.

Both qualifications are Level 3 in the National Qualification Framework (NQF).

1.4 Aims

The aims of these specifications are to encourage candidates to:

- develop their interest in and enthusiasm for a rigorous study of religion and relate it to the wider world;
- treat the subject as an academic discipline by developing knowledge, understanding and skills appropriate to the specialist study of religion;
- adopt an enquiring, critical and reflective approach to the study of religion;

1.5 Prior Learning/Attainment

No prior knowledge of the subject is required. The specifications build on, but do not depend on, the knowledge, understanding and skills specified for GCSE Religious Studies. It is recommended that candidates have attained communication and literacy skills at a level equivalent to GCSE Grade C in English.

2.1 AS Units

Unit G571: AS *Philosophy of Religion*

- Ancient Greek influences on philosophy of religion;
- Judaeo-Christian influences on philosophy of religion;
- Traditional arguments for the existence of God;
- Challenges to religious belief.

Unit G572: AS *Religious Ethics*

- Ethical theories;
- Applied ethics topics.

Unit G573: AS *Jewish Scriptures*

- Time line of scriptures;
- Form criticism;
- Topics.

Unit G574: AS *New Testament*

- First century Gospel setting;
- Themes and texts of Mark's passion narrative;
- The resurrection in the Synoptic Gospels.

G575: AS *Developments in Christian Theology*

- Foundations of Christian theology;
- Liberation theology.

Unit G576: AS *Buddhism*

- Origins of Buddhism;

- Origins of Hinduism;
- Core concepts;
- Key teachings, attitudes and practices.

Unit G578: AS *Islam*

- Background and origins of Islam;
- Beliefs;
- Practices.

G579: AS *Judaism*

- Sacred writings;
 - Beliefs;
 - Practices.
-

2.2 A2 Units

Unit G581: A2 *Philosophy of Religion*

- Religious language;
- Experience and religion;
- Nature of God;
- Life and death;
- Miracle.

Unit G582: A2 *Religious Ethics*

- Meta-ethics;
- Free will and determinism;
- Conscience;

- Reward and punishment;
 - Amos and Hosea;
 - Messianic hope and the ethical kingdom;
 - Ruth;
 - Wisdom literature and religious experience.
-

- Theology of religions;
- Feminist theology.

Unit G586: A2 *Buddhism*

- Key concepts;
- The importance of scriptures;
- Religious practice;
- Later Buddhist developments;
- Ethics.

Unit G587: A2 *Hinduism*

- Key concepts;
- The importance of scriptures;
- Religious practice;
- Later Hindu developments;
- Ethics.

Unit G588: A2 *Islam*

- Beliefs;
- Muslim life;
- Development of Islam.

Unit G589: A2 *Judaism*

- Beliefs;
- Developments in Judaism.

3.1 G571: AS *Philosophy of Religion*

Ancient Greek influences on philosophy of religion

Candidates are expected to have a basic knowledge of the thinking of Plato and Aristotle; they will not be expected to have first-hand knowledge of the texts. They should be able to highlight the strengths and weaknesses in the thinking of Plato and Aristotle in the areas specified below.

Plato: the Analogy of the Cave
The Republic VII. 514A–521B

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of what might be represented in the Analogy of the Cave by the following:

- the prisoners, the shadows, the cave itself, the outside world, the sun, the journey out of the cave and the return to the prisoners.

Candidates should be able to discuss critically the validity of the points being made in this analogy.

Plato: the concept of the Forms;
the Form of the Good

Candidates should understand what Plato meant by 'Forms' and be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- the relation between concepts and phenomena;
- the concept of 'Ideals';
- the relation between the Form of the Good and the other Forms.

Candidates should be able to discuss critically the validity of the above points.

Aristotle: ideas about cause and purpose in relation to God
Metaphysics Book 12

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- Aristotle's understanding of material, efficient, formal and final cause;
- Aristotle's concept of the Prime Mover.

Candidates should be able to discuss critically the validity of the above points.

Candidates should be familiar with Biblical texts to exemplify the topics below. There are no prescribed texts.

The concept of God as Creator

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- the way the Bible presents God as involved with his creation;
- the imagery of God as a craftsman;
- the concepts of omnipotence, omniscience and omnipresence;
- the concept of 'creatio ex nihilo'.

Candidates should be able to:

- compare this view with Aristotle's Prime Mover;
- discuss whether, if God created the universe, God is therefore responsible for everything that happens in it.

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas in a critical manner.

The goodness of God

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- the ways in which the God of the Bible is seen as morally perfect and the source of human ethics;
- the concept of God as lawgiver and as judge.

Candidates should be able to:

- consider whether, in a Biblical context, God commands things because they are good or whether things are good because God commands them.

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas in a critical manner.

Traditional arguments for the existence of God

The Ontological argument from Anselm and Descartes; challenges from Gaunilo and Kant

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- the Ontological argument from Anselm and Descartes;
- challenges to it from Gaunilo and Kant;
- Anselm's understanding of God – his understanding of the differences between contingent and necessary existence;
- Descartes' understanding of existence as a perfection which God cannot lack;
- Gaunilo's analogy of the island in *On Behalf of the Fool*.

Candidates should be able to discuss critically these views and their strengths and weaknesses.

The Cosmological argument from Aquinas and Copleston; challenges from Hume and Russell	Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of: • the Cosmological argument from Aquinas and Copleston; • the arguments put forward by Copleston in the 1948 radio debate with Russell and Russell's counter arguments; • Hume's criticisms of the cosmological argument. Candidates should be able to discuss critically these views and their strengths and weaknesses.
The Teleological argument from Aquinas and Paley; challenges from Hume, Mill and Darwin	Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of: • the teleological argument from Aquinas and Paley; • the challenges to it from Hume, Mill and Darwinism. Candidates should be able to discuss critically these views and their strengths and weaknesses.
The Moral argument from Kant: psychological challenges from Freud	Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of: • the moral argument from Kant, including his concept of the 'summum bonum' and his inferences about innate moral awareness; • psychological challenges from Freud to the moral argument, his view that moral awareness comes from sources other than God. Candidates should be able to discuss critically these views and their strengths and weaknesses.
Challenges to religious belief	
The problem of evil	Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of: • the problem of evil: the classic theodicies of Augustine and Irenaeus; • the nature of the problem of evil and the possible differences between natural and moral evil; • how each theodicy understands the responsibility of God for the existence of evil in the world; • the origins of evil and the role of human free will. Candidates should be able to discuss critically these approaches and their strengths and weaknesses.

Religion and science	Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of: • scientific and philosophical views on the creation of the universe; particularly the debate between Creationism and the Big Bang theory; • Darwinism and various developments of evolutionary theory; • 'Intelligent Design' and 'Irreducible Complexity'; • Religious responses to challenges posed by scientific views. Candidates should be able to discuss critically these views and their strengths and weaknesses.
----------------------	---

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- the concepts of absolutist and relativist morality;
- what it means to call an ethical theory absolutist and objective;
- what it means to call an ethical theory relativist and subjective;
- the terms deontological and teleological.

Candidates should be able to discuss critically these concepts and their strengths and weaknesses.

Ethical theories: Natural Law

Natural Law

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- the origins of Aquinas' Natural Law in Aristotle's idea of purpose;
- Aquinas' ideas of purpose and perfection;
- the use of reason to discover Natural Law;
- the primary and secondary precepts.

Candidates should be able to discuss critically these views and their strengths and weaknesses.

Ethical theories: Kantian ethics

Kantian ethics

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- the difference between the Categorical and the Hypothetical Imperatives;
- the various formulations of the Categorical Imperative;
- Kant's understanding of the universalisation of maxims;
- Kant's theory of duty;
- Kant's ideas of the moral law, good will and the summum bonum.

Candidates should be able to discuss critically these theories and their strengths and weaknesses.

Ethical theories: Utilitarianism

Utilitarianism

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- the classical forms of Utilitarianism from Bentham and Mill;
- the principle of Utility;
- the differences between the Utilitarianism of Bentham and of Mill;
- the Hedonic Calculus, higher and lower pleasures, quantity v. quality, and Act and Rule Utilitarianism;
- the Preference Utilitarianism of Peter Singer.

Candidates should be able to discuss critically these issues and their strengths and weaknesses.

Ethical theories: religious ethics

Religious ethics – a study of the ethics of the religion chosen by the candidate

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- the main ethical principles of the religion studied and how the followers of the religion make ethical decisions;
- the ways in which religion and morality may seem to be linked or be seen as separate from each other;
- how far morality may be seen as dependant on God (Divine Command theory);
- how far religious ethics may be seen as absolutist or relativist;
- how ethical theories may be considered religious.

Candidates should be able to discuss critically these issues and their strengths and weaknesses.

Applied Ethics

The ethical theories:

- Natural Law;
- Kantian Ethics;
- Utilitarianism;
- Religious Ethics.

as applied to the ethical topics below.

Abortion; the right to a child	Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of: • the concept of the 'Sanctity of Life' and how it applies to abortion; • the concept of personhood as applied to abortion; • the right to life as applied to abortion and the rights of all those involved; • the issues of infertility and the right to a child; • the status of the embryo; • whether a child is a gift or a right; • the application and the different approaches of the ethical theories listed above to abortion and the right to a child. Candidates should be able to discuss critically these issues and their strengths and weaknesses.
Euthanasia	Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of: • the concept of the 'Sanctity of Life' and how it applies to euthanasia; • the concept of the 'Quality of Life' and how it applies to euthanasia; • the right to life as applied to euthanasia; • the application and the different approaches of the ethical theories listed above to euthanasia. Candidates should be able to discuss critically these issues and their strengths and weaknesses.
Genetic engineering	Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of: • the ethical questions raised by the different types of genetic engineering to humans, animals and plants; human embryo research; • the application and the different approaches of the ethical theories listed above to genetic engineering. Candidates should be able to discuss critically these issues and their strengths and weaknesses.
War and peace	Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of: • the principles of 'Just War' and its application; • the theories of ethical and religious pacifism; • the application and the different approaches of the ethical theories listed above to war and peace. Candidates should be able to discuss critically these issues and their strengths and weaknesses.

3.3 G573: AS Jewish Scriptures

Candidates should be able to demonstrate thorough knowledge of the set texts and to be able to use them (in paraphrase) in their responses to examination questions.

Background to Jewish Scriptures

The texts listed are to be studied with reference to their date, authorship, purpose and historicity. In discussing the texts candidates should be able to refer to their structure and theological importance as well as simply demonstrating knowledge of their content.

Candidates should be able to comment in detail on the texts in relation to the concepts listed and consider the texts from a traditional Jewish or a critical approach.

A time line of scriptures:
placing Jewish scriptures in their historical context and considering the probable dates of principal events and people, ie the life of Abraham, life of Moses, the Exodus, life of David, the Exile, the life of Isaiah, the Maccabean revolt, the destruction of the Temple

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- the different opinions about the dates of the Jewish scriptures and also, therefore, of the possible dates of the events contained in them.

Candidates should be able to consider two or three of the possible forms of evidence and their possible value and reliability.

Candidates may use either Gregorian or Jewish dating and may employ historical, literary or archaeological evidence.

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.

Form criticism

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- the types of literature found in Jewish Scriptures: myth, history, prophecy, poetry, law, wisdom (hohma), liturgy;
- the origins and purpose of the different types of literature found in Jewish Scriptures;
- the main types of literature found in the Tenakh.

Candidates should be aware of examples of each of these. (Their origins can be viewed either from a traditional Jewish standpoint or from a more modern critical one.)

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.

Covenant

Genesis 1:26–30, (Adam) 8:20–9:29, (Noah) 12, 15, 17 (Abraham); Exodus 19–24 (Moses); 2 Samuel 7 (David); Jeremiah 31 (the new covenant)

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- the idea of covenant as a particularly Jewish concept and of the way in which this idea develops through the listed texts, moving from a largely single-sided agreement on the part of G-d to a two-way agreement between G-d and humanity;
- the development of covenantal ideas: the differences between each of the eight covenants listed and the way in which they show the developing relationship between G-d and the Jews and, in particular, the idea of the Promised Land.

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.

Themes from the Jewish Scriptures: G-d and suffering

G-d and suffering

Job 1–14; 19; 38 & 42

Jonah

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- the unique nature of the books of Jonah and Job;
- the particular teachings about the nature of G-d which are found within them;
- the suffering of the Jews as demonstrated in these texts, in relation to the Jewish understanding of the nature of G-d.

Job: candidates should have good textual knowledge and understanding of:

- the Prologue (chapter 1);
- the impact on Job of G-d speaking from the whirlwind (chapter 38) which led to his acceptance of G-d's will and;
- the Epilogue (chapter 42);
- the first series of arguments with his 'comforters' (chapters 2 – 14) and his suffering (chapter 19).

Jonah: candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the following themes:

- obedience;
- the inability to hide from G-d or resist G-d's wishes;
- the relationship with non-Jews.

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.

The Prophet Elijah:
1 Kings 18, 19, 21

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- the role of the Prophet as exemplified by Elijah;
- the Elijah stories connected with Mount Carmel, Mount Horeb and Naboth's vineyard.

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.

Scripture references in Unit G573 are taken from *Tanach Mesorah Publications* and *Holy Bible NRSV*.

Where quotes from texts appear in examination papers, they will be taken from – *Tanach Mesorah Publications* (1996) 0899062695.

3.4 G574: AS *New Testament*

Candidates should be able to demonstrate thorough knowledge of the set texts and to be able to use them (in paraphrase) in their responses to examination questions.

First Century Gospel Setting

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- common Judaism: monotheism, law and covenant, Jerusalem temple, sacrifice and synagogue;
- the influence and distinctive ideas of the Pharisees, Sadducees, Zealots and Essenes;
- Roman occupation of first-century Palestine and its impact on Jewish life and religion;
- source criticism of the Gospels; its aims; debates about Q; the Synoptic problem: one source solution; two source solution and four source solution; Markan priority.

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.

Mark's Gospel

Mark's Gospel

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the following issues relating to Mark's Gospel:

- historical accuracy;
- intended readership;
- purpose;
- date;
- setting;
- authorship.

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.

Themes and Texts of Mark's Passion Narrative

The Passion story, trial and death of Jesus
Mark 11, 14:1–15:41

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- the significance of the triumphal entry into Jerusalem and temple cleansing for the gospel writer and Jesus;
- the meaning of the Last Supper and its possible links to Passover: comparison with Luke 22:7–23 and 1 Corinthians 11:17–26;
- presentation and historical accuracy of women, Judas, Peter, Pilate;
- Jesus' death as sacrifice and atonement; idea of ransom; idea of covenant and new covenant;
- the role of Romans and Jews;
- use of Old Testament;
- general questions of historicity versus theology;
- presentation of Jesus as Son of God, Son of Man, righteous martyr.

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.

Themes and Texts from the Resurrection Narrative in the Synoptic Gospels

The resurrection narrative in the Synoptic Gospels
Matthew 27:57–28:20; Luke 23:50–24:53, Mark 15:42–16:20

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- resurrection narrative: comparison between the three gospels; debates about historical reliability, understanding of the meaning of the resurrection by each gospel writer;
- the meaning of the resurrection according to each gospel writer; long and short ending of Mark (Mark 16:1–8; 16:1–9; 16:9–20); debates about the lost ending of Mark.

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.

Where quotes from texts appear in examination papers, they will be taken from Holy Bible NRSV (Anglicized edition) Oxford University Press (1995) 0-19-107000-9.

A study of the foundations of Christian theology through particular theologians.

God and creation	Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of Aquinas' teachings on the following: • God's relationship to matter; • God's relationship to angels and to humans. Candidates should be able to discuss critically these issues and their strengths and weaknesses.
Knowledge of God	Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of Calvin's teachings on the following: • natural and revealed knowledge; • God as creator, God as redeemer. Candidates should be able to discuss critically these issues and their strengths and weaknesses.
Human nature	Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of Augustine's teachings on the following: • the relationship of men and women before and after the Fall; • the soul (deliberative and obedient) and its relationship to the body; • sin (concupiscence). Candidates should be able to discuss critically these issues and their strengths and weaknesses.
The person of Christ	Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of James Cone's teachings on the following: • the Jesus of history, the Christ of faith; • Jesus as saviour. Candidates should be able to discuss critically these issues and their strengths and weaknesses.
Interpretation of the Bible	Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of: • hermeneutics as the art of understanding: exegesis and eisegesis; • inspiration and authority of the Bible. Candidates should be able to discuss critically these issues and their strengths and weaknesses.

A study of the main ideas to have evolved from liberation theology in Latin America.

Preferential option for the poor	Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of: • justice and judgement; • the poor as the underside of history; • reversal and development. Candidates should be able to discuss critically these issues and their strengths and weaknesses.
Praxis	Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of: • first and second step praxis; • three mediations: socio-analytic; hermeneutical, practical; • orthodoxy and orthopraxis. Candidates should be able to discuss critically these issues and their strengths and weaknesses.
Hermeneutics	Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of: • process, purpose and function of liberation hermeneutics; • hermeneutical circle; hermeneutic of suspicion; • interpretation of the Bible and key texts used by liberation theologians (in particular the Exodus); • conscientisation. Candidates should be able to discuss critically these issues and their strengths and weaknesses.
Jesus the Liberator	Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of: • types of sin: structural, social, personal; • Jesus the Liberator. Candidates should be able to discuss critically these issues and their strengths and weaknesses.
Base communities	Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of: • organisation, purpose and theology of base communities; • relationship of base communities to the Church. Candidates should be able to discuss critically these issues and their strengths and weaknesses.

Environment and situation	Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of: • types of poverty and oppression; • land and wealth; • alienation and exploitation. Candidates should be able to discuss critically these issues and their strengths and weaknesses.
Influence of Marxism	Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of: • main aims of Marx • Marx's analysis and teaching on exploitation, alienation and false consciousness; • explicit and implicit influence of Marx on liberation theologians. Candidates should be able to discuss critically these issues and their strengths and weaknesses.
Impact and influence of liberation theology	Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of: • other theologies of liberation, eg gay and colour; • responses from Roman Catholic and Protestant Churches. Candidates should be able to discuss critically these issues and their strengths and weaknesses.

3.6 G576: AS Buddhism

Origins of Buddhism

The historical, sociological, economic and religious background in India at the time of the Buddha

Candidates should demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the influence of the following on the Buddha:

- Hindu beliefs and practices;
- contemporary religious ferment;
- challenges to the traditional caste system;
- conflict between the Kshatriya and the Brahmin castes.

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.

Traditional accounts of the life of the Buddha

Candidates should demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the significance of the following:

- the four signs;
- ascetic practices;
- enlightenment;
- teaching;
- the nature of the Buddha's death.

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.

Origins of the sangha

Candidates should demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the following:

- development of vinaya rules;
- lifestyle of bhikkhus and bhikkhunis.

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.

Spread of Buddhism

The early spread of Buddhism

Candidates should demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the following:

- the role of Asoka in spreading Buddhism, fighting corruption in the sangha and formalising the scriptures.

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.

Core Concepts

kamma

Candidates should demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the following:

- the concept of kamma;
- karmic formations and karmic consequences.

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.

nibbana	Candidates should demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the following: • the concept of nibbana; • the differences between nibbana and parinibbana. Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.
samsara and rebirth	Candidates should demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the following: • the concepts of samsara and rebirth; • the cycle of dependent origination; • the use of the Tibetan wheel of life to illustrate the cycle of dependent origination; • the role of kamma; • the five khandas. Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.
The three poisons/three fires – greed, hatred and delusion	Candidates should demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the following: • the three poisons/three fires; • the role of the three poisons/three fires in keeping the wheel of samsara in motion. Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.
The three refuges – Buddha, dhamma, sangha	Candidates should demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the following: • the three refuges and their relative importance; • the importance of the three refuges as a statement of faith, their role as a support for Buddhists, their mutual interdependence, how they might be applied in practice. Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.
The three marks of existence – anicca, anatta, dukkha	Candidates should demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the following: • the concepts of anicca, anatta and dukkha; • the relationship between the three marks of existence and their relative importance; • whether belief in the three marks of existence is helpful or consistent with human experience. Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.

The Four Noble Truths – dukkha, samudaya, nirodha, magga (the eightfold path)

Candidates should demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the following:

- the significance of the teaching delivered in the Deer Park;
- the concepts of and relative importance of the Four Noble Truths;
- the division of the eightfold path into prajna (wisdom), sila (morality) and samadhi (concentration);
- the use of the Four Noble Truths.

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.

The fourfold sangha

Candidates should demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the following:

- the fourfold sangha;
- the vinaya rules;
- the relative status of bhikkhus and bhikkhunis;
- the variations between forest and village dwelling bhikkhus;
- the relationship between the monastic sangha and the laity;
- the difficulties in following vinaya rules;
- the ethical principles and practices for monks and lay people.

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.

The arhat and bodhisattva paths

Candidates should demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the following:

- the relative importance of the arhat and bodhisattva paths in Theravada and Mahayana Buddhism;
- key aspects of each path;
- the stages and perfections of the bodhisattva path.

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.

Attitudes to the Buddha

Candidates should demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the following:

- differing attitudes to the Buddha in Theravada and Mahayana Buddhism;
- the trikaya doctrine;
- the status of the Buddha.

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.

Where quotes from texts appear in examination papers, they will be taken from *Buddhist Scriptures*, trans. E. Conze, Penguin, (1969), 0140440887.

The religious aspects of the Indus Valley civilisation	Candidates should demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the following: the possible links between religious aspects of the Indus Valley civilisation and later Hinduism, such as the 'proto-Siva' seal, goddess images and ritual bathing. Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.
The Aryans	Candidates should demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the following: - migration versus cultural transformation theories; - the possible influence of the Aryans on the development of the class system. Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.
Vedic ritual and theology	Candidates should demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the following: - the status and structure of the Vedas; - the importance of ritual; - the status of the deities. Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.
Core Concepts	
monism, monotheism, polytheism	Candidates should demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the meaning of these terms and be able to discuss them in a critical manner. Candidates should be able to evaluate which term best fits the nature of deity in the Vedas.
karma	Candidates should demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the following: - the concept of karma; - karmic formulations and karmic consequences. Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.
moksha	Candidates should demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the following: - concept of moksha; - the nature of liberation. Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.

samsara and rebirth	Candidates should demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the following: • concepts of samsara and rebirth; • the role of karma. Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.
maya	Candidates should demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the following: • the concept of maya; • the nature of reality. Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.
dharma	Candidates should demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the following: • the concept of dharma; • the importance of duty within Hinduism. Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.
Brahman	Candidates should demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the following: • the nature of Brahman, saguna Brahman and nirguna Brahman. Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.
atman	Candidates should demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the following: • the nature of atman and relationship to Brahman. Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.
jnana	Candidates should demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the following: • the concept of and importance of jnana. Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.
bhakti	Candidates should demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the following: • the importance of bhakti yoga. Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.
Key Teachings, Attitudes and Practices	
Worship	Candidates should demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the following: • the practice of puja; • the importance of the murti; • the relationship between puja and the bhakti path. Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.

varnashramadharma	Candidates should demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the following: • the concept of varnashramadharma; • the mythical origins of the system in the <i>Purusha Sukta</i>. Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.
Relationship between atman and Brahman	Candidates should demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the following: • different interpretations of the relationship between atman and Brahman. Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.
Deities in Hinduism	
The deities	Candidates should demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the following: • differing attitudes towards the deities; • status and relationship of male and female power demonstrated by the deities; • the importance of shakti; • key features and importance of the following deities – the trimurti Brahma, Vishnu, Siva, Ganesha, Kali, Saraswati, Lakshmi; • the role and importance of avatars, especially Krishna and Rama. Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.

Where quotes from texts appear in examination papers, they will be taken from – Zaehner, R. C. (tr & ed) *Hindu Scriptures* Everyman's Library (1992) 1-85715-064-3.

3.8 G578: AS Islam

Background and Origins

Pre-Islamic Arabia: historical, geographic and religious context with a consideration of Jewish, Christian, Zoroastrian and Pagan influences

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- the historical, geographical and religious background, including the particular importance of Makkah as the centre of a number of trading routes;
- how the various influences interacted;
- the environment in which Muhammad was born and Islam was introduced.

The Prophet Muhammad

Muhammad as the final messenger of Allah: the Seal of the Prophets

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- the significance, importance and uniqueness of Muhammad for Muslims;
- Muhammad's upbringing, his life in Makkah and the influences he was under;
- the religious significance of the Night Journey;
- the reasons for and importance of Muhammad's migration to al-Madinah;
- the significance and relative success of Muhammad's dual role as both Prophet and Statesman in al-Madinah;
- the battles and the return to Makkah: Battle of Badr, Battle of Uhud, Battle of al-Khandaq;
- the implications of the social and political environment within which Muhammad lived and worked.

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.

Beliefs

Beliefs about Allah and human relationships

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the following beliefs about Allah:

- Allah as creator, judge and guide
- Tawhid and Shirk;
- the Kalam argument as proof of Allah's existence;
- Islamic beliefs about human rights and responsibilities;
- Islamic beliefs about human responsibility to Allah.

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.

The Qur'an



Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- the particular manner in which the Qur'an was revealed;
- the particular and unique nature of the Qur'an;
- the process of the revelation, with a consideration of the differences in the Surahs revealed at Makkah and those at al-Madinah;
- the manner in which the Qur'an was ultimately compiled by Muhammad's followers and its resulting structure and the infallible status accorded to the text;
- the role it continues to play in the life of Muslims.

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.

Surahs 1 and 96

Surahs 1 and 96 need to be studied in detail with an in-depth consideration of the issues raised within them. In particular candidates need to be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- what Surah 1 teaches about Allah and the relationship between Allah and his people;
- what Surah 96 teaches in relation to the revelation and knowledge of Allah.

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.

The Five Pillars: shahadah, salah, zakah, sawm, hajj and Muslim life

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- the references to the Five Pillars in the Qur'an and Hadith;
- their practical and theological nature, their inter-relationship;
- the effect which their observance has on Muslim life and the ummah.

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.

Worship and the mosque: in Muslim and non-Muslim countries; the Imam and Salat-ul-Jumu'ah (Friday prayers)

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- the function of a mosque;
- the particular role of the Imam in Muslim life as a teacher and leader rather than a priest and of the form of worship practised at Salat-ul-Jumu'ah prayers;
- the architecture and design of the mosque and in particular the practical and theological reasons for these;
- the symbolic nature of aspects of the building such as the dome, the prayer hall and the washing facilities, the importance of an area for study and the practical purpose of items such as the minarets;
- the reason for the absence of figurative portrayal and also on the use of calligraphy; teaching on Shirk.

In approaching these issues candidates need to have considered their implications, significance and differences in Muslim and non-Muslim countries.

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.

Where quotes from texts appear in examination papers, they will be taken from – Abdullah, Yusuf Ali, *The Meaning of the Holy Qur'an* Amana Publications (1995) (seventh edition) 0-915957-55-8.

The importance of Tenakh and Talmud	Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of: • Tenakh and Talmud as Written and Oral Law, respectively, the differences between them. Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.
The origins, content and use of Tenakh	Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of: • the origins of the Tenakh either in traditional belief or through modern criticism; • the principal contents of the Tenakh: Torah, Nevi'im, Ketuvim; the way in which these are used in both daily life and worship; • the purpose of Torah within Judaism as divine revelation to guide the people. Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.
The origins, content, use and purpose of Talmud	Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of: • the origins of both the Jerusalem and the Babylon Talmuds and the principal differences between them; • how the Jerusalem and the Babylon Talmuds came into existence and were brought together; • the use of the Talmud and the ways in which it has continued to develop. Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.
Their importance for Jewish belief and life today	Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of: • the continuing importance of both Oral and Written Torah; • the way in which they are used in and influence Jewish life and worship. Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.
Beliefs	
Ethical monotheism	Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of: • ethical monotheism; Candidates should be able to discuss this area critically.

The nature of a monotheistic G-d	Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of: • G-d as supranatural, personal, good and holy; • the difference between the ethical monotheism of Judaism and pagan monotheism. Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.
The particular role of the Jews as a 'chosen people'	Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of: • the role of the Jews as a 'chosen people' and its relationship to the concept of a royal priesthood. Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.
The role of ethical monotheism for Jewish life today	Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of: • the continuing importance of ethical monotheism for Jewish life today, by observance both of the Ten Commandments and of the 613 mitzvot. Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.
Practices	
halakhah and mitzvot	Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of: • the purpose of the 613 mitzvot and the ways in which these generally affect Jewish life; • the principles of Jewish life, worship and practice, observance and kashrut; • the basis of Jewish life and worship as devotion to G-d and the way in which this is carried out; • kashrut in relation to food, clothes, objects and money. Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.

Worship

Worship in the home and synagogue

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- the forms of worship in the home, private as well as worship as a family, and the purpose and practice of prayer both at set times and spontaneous prayer;
- daily prayer and worship, Sabbath, Yom Tovim, the Pilgrim Festivals, the Rabbinical festivals and later institutions such as Tu B'Shevat and Yom Hashoah;
- the origins, practice and observance of the listed festivals; the relative importance of these festivals.

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.

The roles of men and women; including the laws of purity

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- the roles of men and women within the Jewish family and in worship;
- a comparison of these roles and their origins.
- the question of to what degree they give equality to the persons concerned;
- the laws of niddah (purity) and the use of the mikveh together with its importance in the community.

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.

Where quotes from texts appear in examination papers, they will be taken from – Tanach *Mesorah Publications* (1996) 0899062695, The Complete Art Scroll Siddur Mesorah Publications (1984) 0-89-906655-0.

Religious language

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- religious language – uses and purpose;
- the via negativa (Apophatic way);
- the verification and falsification principles;
- different views on the meaningfulness of religious language;
- the uses of symbol, analogy and myth to express human understanding of God;
- the views of the Vienna Circle, A. J. Ayer, Anthony Flew, Ludwig Wittgenstein and Paul Tillich on religious language.

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically and their strengths and weaknesses.

Religious Experience

Experience and religion

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the following in relation to God and religious belief:

- arguments from religious experience from William James;
- the aims and main conclusions drawn by William James in *The Varieties of Religious Experience*;
- the following different forms of religious experience: visions, voices, 'numinous' experience, conversion experience, corporate religious experience;
- the concept of revelation through sacred writings.

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically and their strengths and weaknesses.

Miracle - a study of how God might interact with humanity, by looking at the concept of miracle

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- different definitions of miracle, including an understanding of Hume;
- the biblical concept of miracle and the issues this raises about God's activity in the world;
- the concept of miracle, and criticisms made by Hume and Wiles;
- the implications of the concept of miracle for the problem of evil.

Candidates should be able to discuss whether modern people can be expected to believe in miracles, and whether miracles suggest an arbitrary or partisan God. Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically and their strengths and weaknesses.

Attributes

Nature of God

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- God as eternal, omniscient, omnipotent and omni-benevolent – and the philosophical problems arising from these concepts;
- the views of Boethius in his discussion of eternity and God's foreknowledge in Book 5 of *The Consolations of Philosophy*;
- the question as to whether or not a good God should reward and punish.

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically and their strengths and weaknesses.

Life and Death; The Soul

Life and death

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- distinctions between body and soul, as expressed in the thinking of Plato, Aristotle, John Hick and Richard Dawkins;
- other concepts of the body/soul distinction;
- different views of life after death: resurrection and reincarnation;
- questions surrounding the nature of disembodied existence;
- the relationship between the afterlife and the problem of evil.

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically and their strengths and weaknesses.

Meta-ethics

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- the use of ethical language – the ways in which different scholars understand how words like 'good', 'bad', 'right', 'wrong' are used when ethical statements are made;
- how meta-ethics differs from normative ethics;
- the different approaches: cognitive and non-cognitive; ethical naturalism, intuitionism; emotivism and prescriptivism and how these apply to ethical statements.

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically and their strengths and weaknesses.

Ethical Topics and Theories: Free Will and Determinism

Free will and determinism

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- hard determinism, soft determinism and libertarianism;
- the views of Darrow, Honderich, Hume and Locke;
- theological determinism (predestination) and religious ideas of free will;
- the influences of genetics, psychology, environment or social conditioning on moral choices;
- the implications of these views for moral responsibility;
- the link between free will, determinism and moral responsibility.

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically and their strengths and weaknesses.

Ethical Topics and Theories: Nature and Role of the Conscience

The nature and role of the conscience

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- the different views of the conscience as God-given, innate or the voice of reason or instilled by society, parents, authority figures;
- whether conscience is a reliable guide to ethical decision-making;
- the views of Augustine, Aquinas, Butler, Newman, Freud, Fromm, Piaget.

Candidates should be able to discuss these views critically and their strengths and weaknesses.

Virtue Ethics

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- the principles of Virtue Ethics from Aristotle;
- the 'agent-centred' nature of Virtue Ethics;
- the concepts of eudaimonia and the Golden Mean;
- the importance of practising the virtues and the example of virtuous people;
- more modern approaches to Virtue Ethics.

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically and their strengths and weaknesses.

Applied Ethics

The ethical theories:

- Natural Law;
- Kantian Ethics;
- Utilitarianism;
- Religious Ethics;
- Virtue Ethics;

as applied to all the applied ethics topics listed below.

Environmental and business ethics

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- the issue of how humans should relate to the environment, its resources and species;
- secular approaches – the Gaia hypothesis;
- issues in business ethics: the relationship between business and consumers; the relationship between employers and employees;
- the relationship between business and the environment; business and globalisation;
- the application and the different approaches of the ethical theories listed above to environmental and business ethics.

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.

Sexual ethics

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- the issues surrounding sexual ethics – premarital and extramarital sex, contraception, homosexuality;
- the application and the different approaches of the ethical theories listed above to sexual ethics.

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.

3.12 G583: A2 Jewish Scriptures

Candidates should be able to demonstrate thorough knowledge of the set texts and to be able to use them (in paraphrase) in their responses to examination questions.

Themes in Jewish Scriptures: Reward and Punishment

Reward and punishment:

Isaiah 53; Jeremiah 7; Ezekiel 18; Daniel 12; Psalm 1; 2 Maccabees 7

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- the concept of reward and punishment as understood by the writers of the set texts;
- an overview of the concepts of reward and punishment with an indication of their development.

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.

Themes in Jewish Scriptures: Amos and Hosea

Amos and a comparison with *Hosea 1–3, 14*

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- the book of Amos, with particular reference to social concerns; a comparison with *Hosea 1–3, 14*.

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.

Themes in Jewish Scriptures: Messianic Hope

Messianic hope and the ethical kingdom, with particular reference to *Isaiah 40–43; Micah*

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- the concept of Messianic hope within the set texts and also of the ethical kingdom found in *Micah*.

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.

Themes in Jewish Scriptures: Ruth

Ruth

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- Ruth as a part of the Ketuvim (Writings) in the Jewish Scriptures;
- the devotion of Ruth to Naomi and the idea that this was possibly written to correct the particularism of Judaism after the Exile and the rebuilding of the Temple;
- the importance of Ruth being shown as the great-grandmother of David.

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.
